

■■ YOUR COMPLETE SUPPORT NETWORK

Nepali Students in South Korea — Resources, Help & Community Guide

Embassy · Student Groups · Legal Aid · Scholarships · Emergency Lines · Mental Health · Updated 2025–2026

12,000+

Nepali students in South Korea

13 Lang.

Danuri helpline in Nepali too

FREE

Legal aid via KLAC (call 132)

24/7

Emergency lines always available

What's Inside

1.	Embassy of Nepal in Seoul — Your First Call
2.	Nepal Consular & Government Online Services
3.	Student Communities — SONSIK & University Clubs
4.	Broader Nepali Community Organisations
5.	Emergency Hotlines at a Glance
6.	Danuri Helpline — Nepali-Language Support 24/7
7.	Immigration Helpline (1345) — Know Your Rights
8.	Legal Aid — Free & Low-Cost Options
9.	Mental Health & Crisis Support
10.	Scholarships — Study for Free or Reduced Cost
11.	Academic & Campus Support
12.	Work, Labour Rights & Wage Protection
13.	Banking, SIM Cards & Settling In
14.	City-by-City Support Centres
15.	Online Nepali Communities in Korea
16.	Master Quick-Reference Card

South Korea is home to a growing Nepali student community. Whether you just arrived or have been here for years, knowing where to turn for help is essential. This guide brings together every major support resource — government, legal, community, mental health, financial — in one place, researched and updated for 2025–2026. Share it with every Nepali student you know.

1. Embassy of Nepal in Seoul — Your First Call

The Embassy of Nepal is the single most important resource for Nepali citizens in South Korea. Contact them first in any emergency, legal crisis, or when you need official documentation.

Address	19, 2-gil Seonjam-ro, Seongbuk-gu, Seoul, South Korea
Phone	+82 (02) 3789-9770 / +82 (02) 3789-9771
Email	korea@mofa.gov.np
Website	kr.nepalembassy.gov.np
Office Hours	Monday–Friday 09:30–17:30 (Closed weekends & public holidays. Appointment recommended.)

What the Embassy Can Do for You

→ Passport Renewal & Emergency Travel Docs If your passport is lost, stolen, or expired, the embassy issues Emergency Travel Documents so you can travel home. Bring your ARC and any remaining ID.
→ Consular Assistance During Legal Trouble If detained by immigration, you have the right under the Vienna Convention to consular notification. The embassy can provide a list of Korean lawyers familiar with Nepali cases.
→ Document Notarisation & Attestation Get your Korean documents attested for use in Nepal (academic transcripts, contracts, etc.) and Nepali documents legalised for use in Korea.
→ Emergency Support Accidents, hospitalisation, death of a family member, or serious crime — the embassy can coordinate emergency welfare support and contact your family in Nepal.
→ Visa Services Information and assistance with Korean visa extensions, re-entry after departure, and Nepali re-entry documentation.
→ Registration of Life Events Birth registration, marriage registration, and other civil documentation for Nepali citizens in Korea.

2. Nepal Consular & Government Online Services

Resource	Website	What It Offers
Department of Consular Services	www.nepalconsular.gov.np	Online passport applications, visa information, consular guidelines, and downloadable forms.
Embassy Portal (Seoul)	kr.nepalembassy.gov.np	Announcements, bilateral news, consular appointment booking, and official notices.

Ministry of Foreign Affairs Nepal	www.mofa.gov.np	Full government directory; useful if the Seoul embassy is unreachable.
Foreign Employment Promotion Board (FEPB)	www.dofe.gov.np	If your study/work situation involves the FEPB (e.g. returning to Nepal after visa issues), this board handles overseas labour matters.

3. Student Communities — SONSIK & University Clubs

SONSIK — Society of Nepalese Students in Korea

SONSIK is the **sole officially registered student organisation** for Nepali students, academicians, and intellectuals in South Korea. Founded in 2004 and legally registered in 2015, it is independent of any corporate, political, or government entity. In January 2026, SONSIK entered a formal collaboration with The Korea Times to better support Nepali students with Korean language and cultural integration.

Phone	+82-10-9586-9603
Email	doc.sonsik@gmail.com
Facebook	facebook.com/npsonsik (12,000+ followers)
Website	sonsik.org.np (check for current status)
YouTube	youtube.com/@SONSIK — orientation videos & guides

What SONSIK Offers

◆ Peer networking across all Korean universities with Nepali students
◆ Academic support and research collaboration opportunities
◆ Cultural events: Dashain, Tihar, Deusi-Bhailo celebrations in Korea
◆ Direct coordination with the Nepal Embassy for student welfare
◆ Orientation guidance for newly arrived students
◆ Emergency welfare support and referrals
◆ Annual scholarship fundraising for economically disadvantaged students (Deusi-Bhailo programme)
◆ Representation for Nepali student interests in Korean academic institutions

University Nepali Student Clubs

Most major Korean universities with significant Nepali student populations have an informal Nepali student group. These are your closest peer network on campus. Ask your university international student office or SONSIK to connect you.

Seoul National University (SNU)	Nepali Student Union
Yonsei University	Nepal Club
Kyungsung University (Busan)	Nepali Student Group
Sungkyunkwan University (SKKU)	Nepali Students (active SONSIK chapter)
KAIST	Nepali Research Students Group
Your University	Ask your international office — most have one

4. Broader Nepali Community Organisations

Nepalese Association in Korea (NAK)

- Nepal House Community Center, Wonnam-dong, Seoul
- Community welfare and cultural programs
 - Korean administrative procedure guidance
 - Language classes (Korean for Nepali speakers)
 - Social events and cultural exchange

Non-Resident Nepali Association — Korea Chapter (NRNA)

- Multiple chapters across Korea
- Diaspora networking across Korean cities
 - Community welfare for longer-term residents
 - Cultural exchange and bilateral advocacy
 - Emergency fund access for Nepali nationals in crisis

5. Emergency Hotlines at a Glance

Number	Service	When to Call
112	Police	Crime, theft, assault, immediate danger
119	Fire / Ambulance	Medical emergency, fire, rescue
1345	Immigration Helpline	Visa, stay status, immigration issues (09:00–22:00)
1577-1366	Danuri Helpline	Nepali-language counselling, crisis support (24/7)
132	Korea Legal Aid (KLAC)	Free legal consultation for foreigners
120	Seoul Dasan Centre	Government info, Press 9 for English (24/7)
1330	Tourist / Interpretation	Emergency interpretation in multiple languages
+82-2-3789-9770	Nepal Embassy Seoul	Consular emergency, passports, legal referrals

6. Danuri Helpline — Nepali-Language Support, 24/7

Danuri is the South Korean government's dedicated multicultural support helpline, operated by the Korean Institute for Healthy Family under the Ministry of Gender Equality and Family. **Nepali is one of only 13 languages** in which full support is available. This is one of the most powerful and underused resources available to Nepali students.

Phone	1577-1366 (free from any Korean phone)
Hours	24 hours a day, 365 days a year

Language	Full counselling in Nepali (■■■■■■■) — no translator needed
Website	www.liveinkorea.kr (portal in 13 languages)
Online chat	One-on-one online counselling at liveinkorea.kr

Services Available in Nepali via Danuri

◆ Crisis Counselling

If you are in emotional distress, facing domestic violence, or in immediate danger, a Nepali-speaking counsellor will guide you through your options.

◆ Legal Information

General guidance on your rights as a foreigner, labour law, and visa issues — in Nepali. Not a substitute for a lawyer, but an essential first step.

◆ Emergency Support & Shelter Referrals

If you need emergency housing (e.g. escaping abuse or a dangerous work situation), Danuri can refer you to shelters and support facilities nationwide.

◆ 3-Way Phone Interpretation

Danuri can join a call between you and a Korean institution (hospital, employer, government office) to interpret in real time.

◆ Life in Korea Information

Practical day-to-day guidance: healthcare, transportation, school enrolment, financial services — all in Nepali.

◆ In-Person Counselling

By appointment, a Danuri counsellor can visit you or you can visit the nearest Danuri centre. Over 230 centres across South Korea.

7. Immigration Helpline (1345) — Know Your Rights

The Korea Immigration Service operates a dedicated hotline for all immigration-related questions. You can call even if you think you may have a problem — they provide information, not enforcement (though they do accept reports of violations).

Phone	1345 (or +82-2-1345 from overseas)
Hours	09:00–22:00 (daily, including weekends)
Languages	Korean, English, Chinese, Vietnamese, and others (request an interpreter for Nepali)
Website	www.immigration.go.kr
HiKorea portal	www.hikorea.go.kr — visa applications, permit renewals, appointment booking

■ Call 1345 to confirm your visa expiry date, permit status, or whether you have any flags on your record.

■ Use HiKorea (www.hikorea.go.kr) to apply for your S-3 part-time work permit without visiting an office.

■ Book immigration office appointments online via HiKorea — walk-in queues are very long.

■ 1345 can clarify whether a specific job or employer is permitted under your visa type before you accept work.

8. Legal Aid — Free & Low-Cost Options

Legal help in South Korea does not have to be expensive. Several government and non-government organisations provide free or subsidised legal consultations for foreigners.

Korea Legal Aid Corporation (KLAC) (■■■■■■■■■■)

■ 132 (any Korean phone) | ■ www.klac.or.kr

- Free legal consultations (up to 70 cases/day online)
- Civil, family, and criminal case representation
- Labour dispute assistance including unpaid wages
- Immigration case guidance
- Phone, online (klac.or.kr), video, and in-person appointments
- Nationwide branches in every major city

Seoul Global Centre (■■■■■■■■■■)

■ +82-2-2075-4180 | ■ global.seoul.go.kr

- Multilingual legal consultations (free)
- Immigration advice and visa guidance
- Employment and labour rights counselling
- Life-in-Korea practical guidance
- Korean language classes

Korean Bar Association Legal Aid Foundation (■■■■■■■■ ■■■■■■)

■ 02-3476-6515 | ■ www.koreanbar.or.kr

- Free legal aid for those unable to afford private lawyers
- Civil, criminal, and administrative cases
- Particularly useful for complex immigration lawsuits

9. Mental Health & Crisis Support

Being far from home, under financial pressure, and navigating a foreign language is genuinely hard. Mental health struggles among international students are common and nothing to be ashamed of. These resources are confidential and many are available in Nepali.

Danuri Helpline — 1577-1366

24/7, in Nepali. Nepali-speaking counsellors trained in crisis response and emotional support. This is your first call if you are in distress. They will not report you to immigration.

National Mental Health Crisis Line — 1577-0199

24/7 Korean crisis line. Ask for an interpreter if needed. For suicidal thoughts, severe depression, or psychiatric emergencies.

Korea Suicide Prevention Hotline — 1393

24/7, free, confidential. If you or someone you know is in immediate danger.

University Counselling Centres

Every accredited Korean university has a free student counselling service. Visit your campus health or student affairs building. Sessions are confidential. Some universities offer counselling in English — ask your international office.

Smile Centre (Seoul) for Foreign Victims

Provides psychological counselling and support specifically for foreign nationals who have experienced crime or trauma in Korea. Contact via Danuri (1577-1366) for referral.

10. Scholarships — Study Free or at Reduced Cost

Global Korea Scholarship (GKS / KGSP)

Administered by: NIIED — National Institute for International Education | www.studyinkorea.go.kr

Benefits: Full tuition + monthly stipend (approx. ■900,000–■1,000,000/month) + airfare + health insurance + settlement allowance + 1-year free Korean language training. 2 Embassy Track seats reserved for Nepal per year (undergraduate). Graduate track has more seats — apply via both Embassy and University tracks.

Eligibility: Undergraduate: under 25, top 20% of class. Graduate: under 40, CGPA 80%+. Nepali citizenship. Apply via Korean Embassy in Kathmandu or directly to universities.

KOICA Scholarship

Administered by: Korea International Cooperation Agency | www.koica.go.kr

Benefits: Fully funded master's degree programme for students from developing countries including Nepal. Covers tuition, living expenses, airfare, and health insurance.

Eligibility: Must be employed in a government or public institution in Nepal. Master's degree or equivalent prior education.

UST (University of Science & Technology) Scholarship

Administered by: Government-funded research university | www.ust.ac.kr

Benefits: Tuition waiver plus monthly stipend for science and engineering graduate students at government-affiliated research institutes across Korea.

Eligibility: Bachelor's or master's degree in science/engineering. Research focus required.

University-Specific Scholarships

Administered by: SNU, Yonsei, KAIST, POSTECH, SKKU, Kyung Hee, and many others | Check each university website

Benefits: Merit-based, need-based, and field-specific scholarships at most Korean universities. KAIST and POSTECH offer near-full funding for STEM graduate students. Ask your international student office immediately upon arrival about available awards.

Eligibility: Varies by university. TOPIK score and GPA are key factors.

SONSIK Student Scholarship Fund

Administered by: Society of Nepalese Students in Korea | facebook.com/npsonsik

Benefits: Community-fundraised scholarships for economically disadvantaged Nepali students in Korea. Raised annually through Deusi-Bhailo cultural events.

Eligibility: Nepali student in Korea with documented financial hardship. Contact SONSIK directly.

11. Academic & Campus Support

International Student Office (■■■■■)

Every Korean university has one. This is your first campus contact for: visa extension documentation, academic difficulty, financial hardship applications, housing issues, and connecting with campus counselling. Visit them within your first week.

TOPIK — Test of Proficiency in Korean

Higher TOPIK level = more part-time working hours and better scholarship prospects. Register at topik.go.kr. Offered 4–6 times per year. TOPIK Level 2 unlocks work permits; Level 3+ unlocks 25 hrs/week. Free prep materials at topikguide.com.

KIIP — Korea Immigration & Integration Programme

A free government Korean language and culture course (5 levels). Completing KIIP levels is accepted as an alternative to TOPIK scores for some work permit purposes and strengthens future visa applications. Register at socinet.go.kr.

Korean Language Classes on Campus

Most universities offer free or subsidised Korean language courses for international students. Check your university's Language Education Centre or student affairs office.

Study Korea 300K Plan

The Korean government's programme to attract 300,000 international students by 2027. This means increasing support services, English-medium programmes, and scholarship availability. See www.studyinkorea.go.kr for the latest updates.

12. Work, Labour Rights & Wage Protection

If you are working legally (with an S-3 permit), you have full Korean labour rights. Employers cannot underpay, withhold wages, or discriminate against you.

Issue	What You Can Do
Minimum Wage 2025	■10,030 per hour (approx. NPR 875). Your employer MUST pay at least this.
Unpaid Wages	Contact the Ministry of Employment and Labour: 1350. They investigate and can order payment. Also use KLAC (132) or Seoul Global Centre for assistance.
Hazardous Work	You cannot be forced into dangerous conditions. Report to 1350 or the occupational safety authority (■■■■■).
Workplace Discrimination	Discrimination based on nationality is illegal. Contact the National Human Rights Commission of Korea: 1331 (www.humanrights.go.kr).
Contract Rights	You are entitled to a written labour contract in a language you understand. If your employer refuses, call 1350.

13. Banking, SIM Cards & Settling In

Opening a Bank Account

You need your ARC (Alien Registration Card) + passport. Most accessible banks for foreigners: KEB Hana Bank, Woori Bank, IBK (Industrial Bank of Korea). IBK has dedicated services for foreigners and publishes Danuri guides. Open your account within the first 2 weeks — you'll need it for rent, tuition, and any legal wages.

Getting a Korean SIM Card

Three main operators: SK Telecom, KT, LG U+. You need your ARC and passport. Budget option: MVNO providers (cheap SIM cards at convenience stores) using the major networks. For Wi-Fi before you get a SIM: your university campus will have free Wi-Fi.

Alien Registration Card (ARC)

Must be applied for within 90 days of arrival if staying more than 90 days. Apply at your local immigration office or online via HiKorea. You MUST carry your ARC at all times — it's your legal ID in Korea.

Health Insurance (NHIS)

International students on D-2 are typically enrolled in the National Health Insurance Service (NHIS) automatically by their university. Premium approx. ■80,000–■100,000/month. D-4 students should check with their institute. Contact NHIS: 1577-1000.

Housing

University dormitories are the safest and cheapest option — apply as early as possible, as they fill quickly. Private options: gosiwon (small rooms, very affordable), hasukjip (boarding house with meals), officetel (studio apartment). FOHO (foreignerhome.com) specialises in rental assistance for foreigners.

14. City-by-City Support Centres

Seoul

Seoul Global Centre: +82-2-2075-4180 | global.seoul.go.kr Seoul Dasan Call Centre: 120 (Press 9 for English) Danuri Centre: 1577-1366 KLAC Seoul: 132

■ Most Nepali students and community organisations are based in Seoul.

Busan

Busan Immigration Office: 051-461-3021 Busan KLAC Branch: 051-505-1643 / 132 Danuri Migrant Centre Busan: 051-508-1366 Kyungsung University Nepali group — active community

■ Busan has a growing Nepali student community. SONSİK held Nepal Grand Festival in Busan (2025).

Daejeon

Daejeon Global Centre: 042-270-4700 KAIST international students office: +82-42-350-2493 KLAC Daejeon: 132

■ KAIST and UST have significant Nepali research student populations.

Daegu / Gyeongbuk

Daegu Global Centre: 053-803-7330 Daegu KLAC: 132 Immigration Office Daegu: 053-230-6000

■ Growing international student population at Kyungpook National University.

Gyeonggi (Suwon / Ansan)

Ansan Foreign Worker Centre: 031-492-8000 KLAC Suwon: 132 Danuri Ansan: 031-492-1366

■ Ansan has one of Korea's largest migrant communities. Strong labour rights support.

15. Online Nepali Communities in Korea

These online spaces are where Nepali students share tips, job leads, housing advice, and warnings about fraudulent consultancies. Join them as soon as you arrive.

Platform	Where	What You'll Find
SONSIK Facebook Page	facebook.com/npsonsik	12,000+ followers. Official SONSİK announcements, events, scholarships.
Nepali Students in Korea (Facebook groups)	Search 'Nepali Students Korea' on Facebook	Multiple active groups for housing, jobs, study tips, and community events.
NRNA Korea (Facebook/Instagram)	Search 'NRNA Korea'	Diaspora events, welfare announcements, community news.
KakaoTalk Group Chats	Ask SONSİK or your university's Nepali group	Most active day-to-day communication happens on KakaoTalk. Request to join your university or city group.
YouTube — SONSİK Channel	youtube.com/@SONSIK	Orientation videos, immigration guidance, cultural content in Nepali.
Reddit r/korea	reddit.com/r/korea	General expat community in Korea — useful for practical life questions in English.

16. Master Quick-Reference Card — Save & Share

Screenshot or print this section and keep it on your phone. Share with every Nepali student you know.

Type	Service	Contact	Notes
■ Emergency	Police	112	Crime / danger
■ Emergency	Fire / Ambulance	119	Medical / fire
■■ Embassy	Nepal Embassy Seoul	+82-2-3789-9770	Mon–Fri 09:30–17:30
■ Immigration	Korea Immigration Helpline	1345	Visa, ARC, permits (09:00–22:00)
■ Nepali Line	Danuri Helpline (in Nepali)	1577-1366	24/7, Nepali counsellors
■ Legal (Free)	Korea Legal Aid Corp (KLAC)	132	Free legal help, nationwide
■ Seoul Info	Seoul Dasan Centre	120	Press 9 for English, 24/7
■ Interpretation	Tourist Interpretation Line	1330	Emergency language help
■ Labour Rights	Ministry of Employment & Labour	1350	Unpaid wages, contracts
■ Mental Health	National Mental Health Crisis	1577-0199	24/7, ask for interpreter
■ Crisis	Korea Suicide Prevention	1393	24/7, confidential
■ Students	SONSIK	+82-10-9586-9603	doc.sonsik@gmail.com
■ Health Insur.	National Health Insurance	1577-1000	NHIS queries
■ Online	HiKorea (permits/visa online)	www.hikorea.go.kr	Visa & permit applications
■ TOPIK	Korean Language Test	www.topik.go.kr	Register for TOPIK exams

Sources: Embassy of Nepal Seoul (kr.nepalembassy.gov.np) · Korea Immigration Service · SONSIK (sonsik.org.np / facebook.com/npsonsik) · Ministry of Gender Equality & Family (Danuri) · Korea Legal Aid Corporation · Seoul Global Centre · NIIED (GKS Scholarship) · The Korea Herald · The Korea Times (Jan 2026 SONSIK collaboration report) · Updated May 2026.